Baseball recruiting calendar, Class of 2029

Class of 2029 · built from rules read 2026-11-05 · written 2026-11-06 · playbook id w10-baseball

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot or playing time. We do not contact coaches or your athlete. **RULE** = a bylaw we cite. **PROJECTED** = calculated from current bylaws, not yet published. **RECOMMENDED / YOUR PLAN** = our suggestion, not an NCAA deadline. Confirm every date with each school's compliance office.

Part A.The picture in one page

Baseball runs on a **later clock** than most D1 sports. Do not use a June 15 date you saw for football or lacrosse.

What opens	Class of 2029 date	Source
D1 calls, texts, emails	RULE 2027-08-01 (start of junior year)	[S1 13.1.3.1.1, 13.4.1.1]
D1 off-campus contact, official visits, athletics-involved unofficial visits	RULE 2027-09-01	[S1 13.1.1.1.1, 13.6.2.1.2, 13.7.1.2]
Recruiting talk at a D1 camp	RULE 2027-09-01	[S1 13.12.1.5.2]
D2 in-person contact and official visits	RULE 2027-06-15	[S2 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2]
D3 official visits	RULE 2028-01-01	[S3 13.6.1.1.1]
Written aid offer (D1)	RULE 2028-08-01	[S1 13.9.3.1]
Signing opens (D1)	PROJECTED 2028-11-08 (second Wednesday in November)	[S1 13.02.13.1(f)]
NAIA	no recruiting calendar and no limit on communication	[S15]

Before a date opens. A family may write a coach, fill a questionnaire or attend a camp at any time; the dates limit what the coach may send or say [S26; S19]. A coach who cannot answer yet is following the rule, not rejecting you.

Academic lines (D1). 10 of 16 core courses finished, 7 in English, math or science, before the seventh semester [S1 14.3.1.1(b)]. 16 cores, 2.300 core GPA, graduate, final transcript [S1 14.3.1.1(a)]. D2 asks 2.2 core GPA [S7]. D3: the school sets its own bar [S7]. NAIA is a separate center; a freshman is eligible with a 2.3+ high school GPA, or two of three: 18 ACT / 970 SAT, 2.0 GPA, top half of class [S13; S14].

Roster reality. D1 settlement schools are capped at 34 baseball players [S9]. A cap is a ceiling on team size, not a count of open spots. Under the old model baseball had 11.7 equivalencies across at most 27 aided players; whether an opted-in school now aids more is a budget decision families cannot see [S8; S9]. D2 limit: 9.0 equivalencies [S11]. D3 gives no athletic aid [S7].

Numbers and honesty. No program or governing body we found publishes numeric baseball standards [S26; S27], and vendors disagree widely on D1 pitcher velocity. So this playbook never states a "D1 number." It shows how to get verified numbers and how to ask programs what they want.

Context, not odds. About 8.8% of high school baseball players appear on an NCAA roster in the same year (2.7% D1, 2.6% D2, 3.5% D3). That is a ratio of two headcounts for 2024-25, it leaves out NAIA and JUCO, and it is not your athlete's chance [S17].

Dated calendar (each row cites its bylaw)

2026-11-15 **Recommended (not NCAA)**

Have the counselor check every course against the NCAA list

Map completed and planned classes against your school's NCAA-approved course list. Not every class counts. This is our recommended date, not an NCAA one.

If missed: Problems found in 12th grade are often too late to fix.

D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-06-15 **Opens**

Division II in-person contact and official visits may begin

D2 coaches may make in-person contact and host paid visits. D2 calls, texts and emails are already allowed at any time.

If missed: None for acting later. Earlier in-person contact is a violation.

D2 Bylaws 13.1.1.1, 13.3.1.2 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90010

2027-08-01 **Opens**

D1 baseball coaches may start calling, texting and emailing

Baseball is different: D1 baseball opens August 1 of junior year, not the June 15 date most sports use. Before this, a coach can't answer a recruiting message, even if your kid sends it first.

If missed: None for starting later. It's an opening, not a race.

D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1.1, 13.4.1.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-08-15 **Recommended (not NCAA)**

Open the NCAA Eligibility Center certification account

D1 and D2 recruits need a certification account ($110 domestic, fee waivers possible) before any D1 official visit. The free Profile Page isn't enough. Recommended date, not an NCAA deadline.

If missed: Without it, a school can't host you on an official visit.

D1 Bylaw 13.6.3 · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/Registration_Checklist.pdf

2027-09-01 **Opens**

D1 baseball off-campus contact and visits may begin

Official visits, unofficial visits involving the athletics department, and off-campus contact all open September 1 of junior year. Recruiting talk at college camps opens the same day. The recruiting calendar can still close a specific week.

If missed: Visiting too early, or during a dead period, is a violation that wastes the trip.

D1 Bylaws 13.1.1.1.1, 13.6.2.1.2, 13.7.1.2 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2028-01-01 **Opens**

Division III official visits may begin

D3 paid visits open January 1 of junior year. D3 offers no athletic scholarships; aid there is academic and need-based.

If missed: None for visiting later.

D3 Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90011

HARD DEADLINE

Finish 10 of your 16 core courses before senior year

Division I requires 10 NCAA-approved core courses, 7 of them English, math or science, finished before the first day of the seventh semester. Those grades lock. Your school sets the exact date.

	If missed: Can block qualifier status and first-year competition. Senior-year courses can't repair it. D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008
2028-11-08	***PROJECTED (not yet published)*** *Projected D1 baseball signing opens* *Calculated from current rules: the second Wednesday in November. Not yet a published calendar date. We recheck it when the NCAA publishes.* *If missed: No penalty for signing later, but a school's offer can expire. Signing ends recruiting by other schools.* *D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008*
2029-04-01	**Window** Final amateurism certification request opens Fall 2029 enrollees can request final amateurism certification in their Eligibility Center account from April 1. It's when the window opens, not a cutoff. If missed: Not an automatic loss, but waiting can delay clearance to compete. Eligibility Center procedure · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/How_to_Request_Final_Amateurism_Certification.pdf
	HARD DEADLINE Graduate and get final certification Finish all 16 core courses with at least a 2.3 core GPA, graduate, and have the school send the final transcript to the Eligibility Center. A transcript GPA isn't the same as a core GPA. If missed: Can delay or block first-year competition. A verbal commitment isn't clearance. D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.3 · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/IE_Brochure.pdf

The stages at a glance

Stage 0. Home base (one evening, before 2027-08-01)
Done when: folder exists, Sunday slot is on both calendars, C1 has a dollar figure.

Stage 1. Lock the academics (now; recheck each semester)
Done when: C4 shows 10/7 reachable and the account number is in the folder. If not, book the counselor this week and ask in writing for the course plan that gets there.

Stage 2. Get verified numbers (spring and summer 2027, YOUR PLAN)
Done when: every number in C5 has a date and a measurer. None is "self-timed."

Stage 3. Video and profile (before 2027-08-01)
Done when: a stranger can open the link on a phone, C5 fits one page, C6 has no open items.

Stage 4. Target list (before 2027-08-01)
Done when: C2 has 30 rows, each filled or marked "unknown."

Stage 5. First contact
Done when: 20 messages are logged, no reply is unanswered, no follow-up is more than 3 days overdue.

Stage 6. Showcases, camps, visits (2027-09-01 onward)
Done when: every event has a C8 row, total spend is under C1, every visit has a C10 score dated within 24 hours.

Stage 7. Offers, comparison, signing (2028-08-01 onward)
Done when: C11 has no blank cell for the offer being accepted, and athlete and parent chose together.

Sources used: S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S7, S8, S9, S11, S13, S14, S15, S17, S19, S20, S26, S27, S28, S29, S31, S33, S34, S35, S36, S37, S38, S40. Table: `../shared/SOURCES.md`. Full source table is in the Commit Book. Education, not legal advice. Rules change; check the cited source and each school's compliance office before acting. The Recruiting Calendar.